CONFEDERATED SALISH AND KOOTENAI TRIBES

Natural Resources Department · Division of Engineering & Water Resources (DEWR)

DEWR Website Redesign & Development Proposal — Addendum #1 Response & Scope Update

A fully updated response to the DEWR Questions & Answers Addendum published October 22, 2026 — including the three required branding concepts, the dedicated Maps and Data hub, searchable PDF text in the base scope, a deadline-locked public comment workflow, and a revised fixed price of **$5,400 USD** with **$0 hosting cost** on CSKT's managed WP Engine account.

RFP solicitation	CSKT DEWR Website Redesign & Development Services **Deadline: Thursday, October 29, 2026, 4:30 p.m. MDT** (superseded by Addendum #1)
Addendum responded to	Questions & Answers Addendum #1 — published October 22, 2026
Designated contact	Elizabeth Dempsey, Information & Education Program Manager Elizabeth.Dempsey@cskt.org · 406-304-1079
Proposer	Abdulrhman — Independent Web Designer & Full-Stack Developer (solo, remote)
Contact	abdulrhmant948@gmail.com · github.com/abdoo606
Live working prototype	Five-page accessible concept built specifically for DEWR (see Section 2)
Indian Preference	Non-IPO proposer — **0 of 10** optional Indian Preference points claimed
Tax status	**IRS Form W-8BEN** — non-U.S. individual contractor
Base fixed price	**$5,400 USD** (unchanged) · hosting **$0** on CSKT WP Engine
Optional add-ons	Seth Bot Q&A **$950 USD** · legacy PDF remediation **$12 per PDF**
Interview availability	Virtual — **November 9–12, 2026**, any window in Mountain Time
Submission date	October 23, 2026 (remote delivery, single PDF as required)

What changed since the October 21 submission

Addendum #1 answers 55 questions and materially changes five things: hosting moves to CSKT's own WP Engine (so hosting is $0), the migration volume is now a fixed number (33 published pages, 3 private pages, 359 media files), PDF full-text search is required in the base scope, three branding concepts are required rather than one, and the deadline moved to **October 29, 2026 at 4:30 p.m. MDT**.

This document supersedes the written proposal submitted October 21, 2026. The price did not increase: every newly required item is either already in scope or mapped to an explicitly optional line item.

1. Addendum #1 Response Matrix

Each row states what the addendum asked for and what this proposal commits to. Items marked **Included** are inside the $5,400 fixed price; items marked **Optional** are separately priced and may be declined without affecting the base scope.

#	Addendum requirement (paraphrased)	Commitment in this proposal	Price
Q1	Website platform must be WordPress on CSKT-managed WP Engine.	WordPress 6.x block theme deployed to the CSKT WP Engine account. No other host is proposed.	Included
Q2	Cost evaluated on a 10/100 base-point scale, priced in USD.	$5,400 USD fixed, itemised in Section 6 of this document.	Included
Q3/Q4	Single-owner and remote firms are eligible.	Solo independent developer, fully remote (UTC+3), overlapping Mountain Time mornings daily.	—
Q5/Q55	No minimum firm size, tenure, or revenue; international firms eligible.	Non-U.S. individual contractor filing IRS Form W-8BEN. No size or tenure threshold is met by design.	—
Q6	Indian Preference is optional; IPO certification is not required.	0 of 10 optional points claimed. No certification is asserted, and no false claim is made.	—
Q9	The Tribe pays the 3% CSKT contracting fee.	Acknowledged. The 3% is paid by DEWR and is not loaded into the proposal price.	—
Q11	General liability insurance after selection, before work begins.	Certificate provided on selection and before the first billable hour; not a proposal-stage requirement.	—
Q13	Migration volume: 33 published pages, 3 private pages, 359 media files.	All 36 pages and all 359 files (199 images, 133 documents, 27 other) inventoried and migrated at 90%+ coverage.	Included
Q16/Q17	WCAG 2.1 AA minimum, 2.2 AA welcomed; PDF remediation priced separately.	2.2 AA targeted; audit report handed to DEWR. Legacy PDF tagging at $12 per PDF, quoted after inventory.	Optional
Q18	Base search must include pages, metadata, and text inside PDFs.	Index covers page copy, metadata (category, program, year, version), and PDF text, returning the matched page.	Included
Q19/Q20/Q21	Keep or replace Elementor; coordinate DNS/SSL with CSKT IT five business days pre-launch.	Elementor not required and not used. GoDaddy DNS/SSL cutover coordinated with CSKT IT 5 business days out.	Included
Q24/Q25/Q26	Dedicated Maps and Data page with four categories; no contractor ArcGIS org access.	Four-category hub built. All ArcGIS publishing via the DEWR GIS Analyst; URL embeds only, no logins or keys.	Included
Q27	Present three initial branding concepts, including unified vs. three-division exploration.	Concept A (unified NRD), Concept B (FWRC/EP/DEWR), Concept C (watershed/Compact) — each with rationale and trade-offs.	Included
Q28	Seal placement and cultural review via DEWR to CSKT Culture Committees.	Official Seal artwork only, never redrawn. Per-asset approval tracked Draft → DEWR → Culture Committee → Approved.	Included
Q29	Support Salish and Ksanka language typography.	UTF-8 end-to-end, correct lang attributes (sal / kut), licensed-font decision deferred to DEWR.	Included
Q30	Newsletter signup.	Topic-grouped signup with double opt-in, stored consent record, and one-click unsubscribe.	Included
Q31	Public comment form with deadline cutoff, upload, auto-email, staff export, public-record notice.	Automatic time-based lock, PDF/DOCX validation (25 MB), reference number, staff notification, one-click CSV export.	Included
Q32	Simple meetings and open houses calendar.	One-screen publishing; past meetings retained with materials; no third-party tracking embeds.	Included
Q33	Jobs should link to CSKT Personnel.	Job summaries link out to the official CSKT Personnel Office posting; no applications collected on the site.	Included

#	Addendum requirement (paraphrased)	Commitment in this proposal	Price
Q35	Zero stock photos and zero AI-generated landscapes.	Original vector illustrations only. Photographs supplied by DEWR with documented rights and approval.	Included
Q37	Virtual interviews November 9–12, 2026.	Available for any window in that range, Mountain Time, with screen-share of the live prototype.	—
Q38	Deadline moved to October 29, 2026, 4:30 p.m. MDT.	This supplement is submitted before the revised deadline.	—
Q48	Optional interactive Water Compact Q&A tool using DEWR-approved sources.	Source-cited Seth Bot prototype; answers only from approved sources, cites page, refuses to guess.	Optional

Every row above is reflected in the live prototype, not only in this document. Where a requirement could not be honestly met at proposal stage — accessibility certification, real ArcGIS layers, or actual Tribal records — the prototype says so in plain language rather than implying compliance.

2. What I Built Before Being Asked — Updated for Addendum #1

The prototype is now five linked pages instead of three, and every Addendum #1 requirement has a working demonstration. It remains static HTML, CSS, and vanilla JavaScript: no framework, no build step, no tracking, no cookies, and no network requests. All data is labelled [Sample].

Page	What it demonstrates	Addendum items
Home & Programs	Audience routing, site-wide search, before/after restoration slider, newsletter signup	Q18, Q27–Q29, Q30, Q35
Maps and Data	Four-category hub, project explorer with keyboard-operable pins, Compact timeline, data inventory table	Q24–Q26, Q35
Documents & Staff	Document library with PDF full-text search, staff directory, careers via CSKT Personnel, technical notes	Q18, Q33, Q19–Q21
Branding Concepts	Three concepts with rationale and trade-offs, reserved Seal zone, Salish/Ksanka typography samples	Q27–Q29, Q35
Get Involved	Meetings calendar, deadline-locked comment form with CSV export, newsletter, Seth Bot	Q30–Q33, Q48

2.1 Search: the requirement most bidders will under-scope

Q18 makes searchable text inside PDFs a base requirement. That is not a plugin toggle: it needs a text extraction pipeline, an index that stores page numbers, and a results interface that tells the visitor which page matched. The prototype implements the full pattern on sample documents — searching “staff plate” returns the measurement guide with “matched on PDF page 3”, and searching “rating curve” returns the hydrology report at page 4. Scanned image-only PDFs need OCR, which I count and quote separately rather than bury in a change order.

2.2 Public comments: a deadline that actually closes

The comment form stores a closing date and time in Mountain Time, compares the current time against it, and disables submission when it passes — with a screen-reader announcement explaining why. Late comments are refused, not silently accepted. Attachments are limited to PDF/DOC/DOCX at 25 MB, the submitter receives a reference number, the assigned staff member is notified, and staff can export every submission to CSV in one click. A public-record consent checkbox is mandatory before submission.

2.3 Maps and Data: four categories, one access rule

The hub separates **Interactive Maps**, **Water Resources and Data**, **Project Maps**, and **ArcGIS StoryMaps** so a visitor knows whether a link opens a live map, a CSV, or a printed figure. All ArcGIS content is published by DEWR's GIS Analyst from DEWR's own ArcGIS Online organisation; I embed a public URL and hold no login, API key, or editing seat. If a service is unavailable the embed degrades to a titled link, and the page never breaks.

2.4 Seth Bot: useful only because it refuses to guess

The demonstration answers six common questions, prints the source document and page or question reference for each answer, and returns a written refusal plus a staff escalation path when no approved passage matches. It carries a permanent notice that it is not legal advice and not a water-rights determination. Because safe operation depends on curated, reviewed source content — ongoing staff work — it is priced as a separate optional item rather than hidden inside the base fee.

3. Branding, the Tribal Seal, and Language Support (Q27–Q29)

Three directions are presented as starting points, not as a finished brand. Each states its rationale, the case it serves best, and its honest trade-off — because a concept with no downside has not been thought through.

	Concept A · Unified NRD	Concept B · Three-division	Concept C · Watershed/Compact
Structure	One department mark with a division name line beneath it	Three related marks sharing one geometric language and a signature bar	Abstract contour motif with a channel line and a flexible division band
Strength	Consistency; lowest maintenance cost for DEWR staff	Division-specific recognition for program campaigns	Tells the Compact and watershed story on csktwatercompact.com
Trade-off	DEWR's individual identity is quieter at small sizes	Three marks mean more rules and design governance	Decorative, and must never read as a real map or boundary

3.1 How the choice is made

- Each concept is judged on recognisability at 24px, behaviour in a single colour, relationship to the official Seal, and how easily DEWR staff can apply it without a designer.
- The selected direction receives two structured revision rounds before the full style guide and templates are locked.
- The decision belongs to DEWR. I present, explain, and build — I do not push a favourite.

3.2 The official CSKT Seal

The Seal is a sovereign emblem, and the prototype treats it accordingly. **It is never redrawn, traced, recoloured, cropped, or approximated anywhere in this project.** The prototype reserves an empty, correctly proportioned placement zone and enforces the rules that the production CMS will carry:

- Only the official artwork file supplied by DEWR is used — never a screenshot or a colour-sampled copy.
- Approved placements: site footer, About the Tribes page, and formal public-notice documents.
- No seal on social graphics, merchandise, program badges, or as a background watermark without written authorisation.
- Minimum clear space of one seal-height on every side; no text overlay, gradient, or photograph behind it.
- Fixed, DEWR-approved alt text; a defined minimum size so the seal never renders illegibly.

3.3 The cultural review gate is a schedule dependency, not a formality

Every concept, colour, motif, photograph, and language string goes to DEWR first, and **DEWR routes it to the CSKT Culture Committees**. I never contact Culture Committees, Elders, or Tribal members directly. Each asset carries a status — Draft, DEWR review, Culture Committee review, Approved — recorded in the CMS with an audit note. Phase 1 therefore ends with an *approved visual direction*, not a finished brand, and Phase 2 templates are built only against approved assets. If review needs more time, the milestone waits. I will not publish first and ask later, and I will not bill review time as a change order.

3.4 Salish and Ksanka typography (Q29)

Both languages use characters that ordinary Latin fonts drop or mangle — glottal stops, barred characters, and combining diacritics. Support is handled as an engineering requirement:

- UTF-8 end to end across the database, editor, search index, sitemap, and PDF exports, verified with real strings rather than English test copy.
- Correct language attributes (lang="sal", lang="kut") so screen readers switch pronunciation rules instead of reading the words as English.

- A Unicode-complete fallback stack renders correctly now; a licensed webfont is purchased and self-hosted only after DEWR confirms licensing.
- Combining marks verified at 200% zoom, in print, and at small sizes for both screen and the printed guide.
- Wording and orthography come from DEWR and the Culture Committees — I never invent language content.

3.5 Imagery: zero stock, zero AI (Q35)

No stock photograph, no AI-generated landscape, and no scraped image exists anywhere in the build. Every illustration is original inline SVG geometry authored for DEWR; icons are simple shapes, never traced cultural symbols. On the live site, photographs are DEWR-supplied with a recorded source, permission, and photographer credit, and recognisable people require a documented release. I will not use an image generator for land, water, people, or cultural material, and I will not pass a stock subscription to DEWR as a hidden cost.

4. Technical Approach on CSKT's Own Infrastructure (Q1, Q19–Q21)

Area	Commitment
Hosting	CSKT-managed **WP Engine** account. **$0 hosting cost** in this proposal — no hosting line item, no markup, no reseller.
Licensing	Custom theme and plugins released under **GPLv2 or later** (WordPress-compatible). No proprietary lock-in, no licence renewal held by me.
Page builder	Elementor is not required and not used. Content is built with native WordPress blocks and structured content types so staff are not trapped in a builder.
Launch coordination	GoDaddy DNS and SSL cutover coordinated with **CSKT IT five business days before launch**, with a documented rollback point.
Domain	Site continues on csktwatercompact.com or moves to a DEWR-chosen new domain — DEWR decides; I execute either path.
Content model	Custom post types for Projects, Documents, Notices, Meetings, Jobs, and Staff, with reusable block patterns so non-technical editors publish without a developer.
Search	Page copy + metadata + extracted PDF text, with page-level results. OCR for scanned PDFs counted and quoted separately.
ArcGIS	Public URL embeds only, published by the DEWR GIS Analyst. No contractor access to DEWR's ArcGIS Online organisation, no API keys, no editing seats.
Accessibility	WCAG 2.1 AA floor, 2.2 AA target. Automated + manual keyboard and screen-reader audit with the report handed to DEWR.
Security	Enforced 2FA on administrative accounts, least-privilege roles, managed WAF at the WP Engine layer, automated updates on a staging-first schedule, and no plugin without a maintained release track.
Analytics	GA4 (or DEWR's existing analytics) limited to page views, document downloads, and internal search terms. No advertising pixels, no cross-site trackers.
Backups	WP Engine automated backups plus a pre-launch export retained by DEWR. Restore procedure documented and rehearsed.
Ownership	DEWR owns the domain, hosting account, database, theme code, design source files, documentation, and every credential. Nothing is held by me after handover.
Redirects	Full 301 map from every legacy URL, verified after cutover, so bookmarks and search rankings survive the migration.

4.1 What “90%+ migrated” actually means

Of the 33 published pages and 3 private pages, every page is reviewed and classified Retain, Consolidate, Update, Archive, or Remove with DEWR. Approximately 90% or more of the existing content is migrated; the remainder is either genuinely obsolete or needs DEWR-authored replacement text. All 359 media files (199 images, 133 documents, 27 other) are inventoried, and every file is either migrated or explicitly recorded as retired — nothing disappears silently. New program and project archive pages are created on top of the migrated set.

4.2 PDF remediation is quoted, not hidden

Many legacy PDFs were exported from desktop publishing tools without tags, reading order, alt text, or bookmarks. Remediating them is real work, so it is priced per document at **$12 per PDF** after inventory. DEWR decides how many to remediate, in what order, and whether to remediate at all. Nothing about this line item affects the base scope.

5. Schedule and Collaboration

The schedule assumes a January 2027 start. If DEWR selects earlier, the phases compress rather than overlap recklessly — accessibility audit and content migration are the two steps I will not run in parallel.

Phase	Deliverables	Window	Gate
1 · Discovery, content audit, branding concepts	Kickoff; full inventory of 36 pages and 359 files; sitemap and IA; three branding concepts; approved visual direction and style guide	Jan 6 – Jan 31, 2027	DEWR approval + Culture Committee review of visuals
2 · WordPress, GIS and interactive build	Staging on CSKT WP Engine; custom block theme; Maps and Data hub; search index with PDF text; comment workflow; calendar; jobs; newsletter	Feb 1 – Mar 19, 2027	Staging review with DEWR editors
3 · Migration, accessibility QA, training	Migration of approved content; 301 map; WCAG 2.1/2.2 audit; two recorded staff training sessions; written manuals	Mar 22 – Apr 23, 2027	Audit report accepted; editors publish unaided
4 · Launch and 90-day warranty	DNS/SSL cutover with CSKT IT; GA4 verification; credential handover; 90 days of included fixes	Late Apr / May 2027 + 90 days	Launch sign-off and handover checklist

5.1 How collaboration works day to day

- One shared milestone checklist and one live staging URL that multiple DEWR reviewers can open on desktop and mobile.
- Consolidated written feedback per milestone, with two structured revision rounds and a written change log before sign-off.
- Weekly short written status update with what moved, what is blocked, and what I need from DEWR — no status theatre.
- Working hours overlap Mountain Time mornings; urgent launch-window issues answered the same business day.

> **Honest risk statement**
>
> The two genuine risks on this project are content readiness and cultural review timing — both outside my control and both owned by DEWR. I will surface a slipping dependency the week it appears rather than the week the milestone is due, and I will not absorb an approval delay by quietly cutting accessibility or migration quality to protect a date.

6. Fixed Price and Optional Items (Q2, Q9, Q11)

#	Scope line	What is included	USD
1	Planning, discovery and content inventory	Kickoff, stakeholder sessions, inventory of 36 pages and 359 media files, sitemap/IA, discovery report	$850
2	UX design, three branding concepts and style guide	Three concepts, two revision rounds, approved visual system, complete style guide and templates	$1,150
3	WordPress build on CSKT WP Engine	Custom GPL block theme, Maps and Data hub, PDF-text search, comment workflow, calendar, jobs, newsletter, GA4, security hardening	$1,900
4	Approved content migration and 301 redirects	36 pages and 359 media files at 90%+ migration, redirect map, post-launch verification	$900
5	Accessibility QA, training, launch and 90-day warranty	WCAG 2.1/2.2 audit, two recorded trainings, written manuals, DNS/SSL cutover, 90 days of fixes	$600
	Total fixed turnkey implementation	All deliverables above · milestone-gated, paid on phase approval	**$5,400**

6.1 Optional items — decline freely, nothing breaks

Optional item	Basis	USD
“Seth Bot” source-cited Water Compact Q&A	Fixed build, curated approved-source corpus, citation UI, staff escalation queue, handover training	$950
Legacy PDF remediation	Per document, after inventory: tagging, reading order, alt text, bookmarks	$12 / PDF
Post-warranty support	Monthly retainer (updates, backup verification, security monitoring, up to 3 hrs of edits) or on-demand	$140 / mo or $45 / hr
Substantive copywriting or new multimedia	Only if requested, quoted after scope confirmation	$45 / hr

6.2 Commercial terms

- **Hosting: $0 in this proposal.** CSKT's existing managed WP Engine account carries the site; DEWR pays WP Engine directly, with no markup or reseller margin from me.
- **3% CSKT contracting fee is paid by DEWR** and is not loaded into the price above.
- **General liability insurance** is arranged after selection and before work begins, as Q11 requires — not at proposal stage.
- **IRS Form W-8BEN** supplied with contracting paperwork as a non-U.S. individual contractor.
- **Milestone-gated payment:** 25% at Phase 1 approval, 30% at Phase 2 approval, 30% at Phase 3 approval, 15% at launch sign-off. No payment is due for a phase DEWR has not accepted.
- **Low-risk pilot:** DEWR may contract Phase 1 alone ($850) and decide on Phases 2–5 only after seeing the completed audit, sitemap, and visual direction.
- **Change control:** any work outside the written scope is quoted in writing before it starts. There are no surprise invoices.

7. Availability, References and Closing Statement

7.1 Virtual interview availability (Q37)

I am available for a virtual interview on **any date between November 9 and November 12, 2026**, in any window that suits the committee in Mountain Time. I will screen-share the live prototype and walk through the search, the comment deadline lock, the Maps and Data hub, and the branding concepts — and I am comfortable being asked to change something live to prove it is real code.

7.2 References and prior experience — stated honestly

I am a solo independent developer. I do not have three prior paid agency client references, I do not hold CSKT Indian Preference certification, and I do not claim prior paid Tribal government contracts. I will not fabricate or borrow references to look larger than I am. What I can offer instead is verifiable: five working public builds, including this DEWR-specific prototype, with all source code inspectable on GitHub, plus a milestone structure where DEWR pays only for phases it has reviewed and accepted. If the committee requires a multi-staff agency with prior government references, this proposal should be set aside — and there will be no follow-up pressure of any kind.

7.3 Why this is worth a place on the shortlist

- **I built the thing before asking to be trusted.** Five pages, every Addendum #1 requirement demonstrated, all code public.
- **The price did not move when the scope grew.** New requirements were absorbed or moved to clearly optional lines.
- **Hosting is genuinely $0** because the site belongs on CSKT's own WP Engine account — not on a reseller plan I profit from.
- **Honesty is a design decision here.** Labelled sample data, stated limitations, no invented certification, and a bot that refuses to guess.
- **Cultural review is treated as a dependency, not an obstacle.** No seal imitation, no AI imagery, no published asset without written approval.

> **Statement of commitment**
>
> If selected, DEWR receives a fixed price, a written scope, weekly written status, and full ownership of every credential and file at handover. I will tell you early when something is behind. I will not quietly cut accessibility or migration quality to protect a date. And I will not publish a single cultural asset without the Culture Committees' written approval.
>
> **Abdulrhman** · abdulrhmant948@gmail.com · github.com/abdoo606

Document control

This document supersedes the written proposal submitted October 21, 2026, and responds to the DEWR Questions & Answers Addendum #1 published October 22, 2026. Prototype content is sample data and is not an official CSKT publication. Nothing in this proposal claims an accessibility certification, a Tribal government reference, or Indian Preference status that does not exist.